

Benson Kamotho Njiru

Nairobi, Kenya | +254 700 249 899 | kamothonjiru@gmail.com | [LinkedIn](#) | [Github](#)

CEH and Certified CyberOps Associate with hands-on enterprise infrastructure experience and deep technical expertise across Linux and Windows environments. Leverages practical infrastructure experience from the State Department for Housing and Urban Development to specialize in network security engineering, with a focus on deploying Next-Generation Firewalls (NGFWs), enforcing strict VLAN segmentation, implementing secure remote access, and conducting comprehensive vulnerability assessments. Deeply passionate about engineering resilient network architectures, identifying critical vulnerabilities, and continuously strengthening an organization's overall security posture.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Ethical Hacking & Penetration Testing: Kali Linux, OpenVAS, Metasploit, Reporting

Vulnerability Assessment & Risk Management: OWASP TOP-10, Nessus

Networking & Network Security Analysis: Snort, EVE-NG, Firewalls, routing and switching.

CTF Competitions & Problem Solving: TryHackMe, PicoCTF, CyberDefenders and MetaCTF

Digital Forensics & Incident Response: Evidence acquisition and analysis

SOFT SKILLS

Analytical Thinking & Problem Solving

Good Communication Skills

Technical Documentation & Reporting

Team Collaboration & Knowledge Sharing

Time Management & Prioritisation of tasks

Self-Learning & Research Aptitude

WORK EXPERIENCE

State Department for Housing and Urban Development, Nairobi | ICT Trainee | May 2025 - Aug 2025

- Supported senior ICT infrastructure engineering teams in auditing and maintaining secure network access protocols across an enterprise government network environment.
- Hardened end-user computing baselines by executing Windows operating system installations, deploying secure system image configurations, and managing bare-metal system recovery plans.
- Minimized technical departmental downtime by utilizing structured troubleshooting diagnostics to isolate and resolve complex hardware faults, network access issues, and internal software errors.
- Maintained and audited technical standard operating procedures (SOPs), establishing consistent tracking documentation and knowledge-base references for technical support personnel.

EDUCATION

BSc. Computer Security and Forensics

Meru University of Science and Technology, Meru, Kenya | Aug 2022 – Expected Graduation Oct 2026

CERTIFICATIONS

Certified Associate Penetration Tester (CAPT) | Hackviser | Ongoing

Huawei HCIA – Security | Huawei ICT Academy | Ongoing

Cisco Ethical Hacker | Cyber Shujaa | Apr 2026

Advent of Cyber 2025 | TryHackMe | Dec 2025

Cisco CyberOps Associate | Cisco Networking Academy | May 2025

MetaCTF Certificate | MetaCTF 2025 | Feb 2025

Operating Systems | Cisco Networking Academy | Nov 2024

Email Security | Udemy | Sep 2024

Introduction to Threat Landscape | Fortinet Training Institute | Mar 2024

PROJECTS & PRACTICAL EXPERIENCE

ML-Powered Phishing Analysis Web App | Jan 2026 - Present

- Engineered a responsive web application designed to intercept and detect sophisticated phishing campaigns that bypass standard email gateway filters.
- Integrated machine learning classification models and Threat Intelligence APIs to analyze raw email artifacts and generate comprehensive user risk profiles.
- *Tools & Frameworks:* React, PostgreSQL, Scikit-learn, XGBoost, FastAPI, Git.

Network Security & IDS Deployment | Mar 2025 - Present

- Designed and deployed segmented enterprise architectures using EVE-NG and Huawei Talent Hub, implementing robust Cisco VLAN schemes and multi-zone Fortinet firewall policies.
- Configured and tuned a Snort IDS sensor to monitor transit traffic across target network segments, achieving a 99% detection rate for simulated intrusion vectors.

Penetration Testing Simulation | Oct 2024 - Present

- Conducted comprehensive vulnerability assessments on virtual network environments using Kali Linux offensive toolsets, including Nmap, Metasploit, and Nikto.
- Identified critical security flaws and system misconfigurations, translating raw data into a structured remediation report with prioritized risk-mitigation strategies.

Cybersecurity Competitions & CTFs | Jan 2023 - Present

- Compete globally (Alias: *4n0nym455*) across TryHackMe, PicoCTF, and CyberDefenders, solving web exploitation, reverse engineering, and digital forensics challenges.
- Led a four-member team to *1st Place* at the Cyberweek Africa 2025 Hackathon, securing the top position among university competitors continent-wide.

HONORS & ACHIEVEMENTS

- **Cyber Shujaa CEH** (Apr 2026): Graduated with Distinction from Cyber Shujaa programme, demonstrating competency in ethical hacking methodologies and tools.
- **1st Place - Cyberweek Africa 2025 Hackathon** (Oct 2025): Led a team of four to victory out of university competitors continent-wide by coordinating technical tasks under tight deadlines, earning a KES 100,000 grand prize.

REFEREES

Dr. Dorothy Bundi | Course Advisor, Computer Security & Forensics | Meru University of Science and Technology | dbundi@must.ac.ke | +254 721 341 185

Dr. Amos Chege | Director RICE, MUST Innovations | Meru University of Science and Technology | achege@must.ac.ke | +254 720 984 636

Martin Musembi | ICT Deputy Director | State Department for Housing & Urban Development | mweumartin@gmail.com | +254 721 830 051
